# Trust Thamesmead

## COMMUNITY NEWSLETTER







**Over 14,000 people enjoyed Thamesmead's Millennium Festival and Carnival. It was a fantastic day for the community of Thamesmead and Abbey Wood. There was an infusion of colour and creativity throughout the day. Held at Birchmere Park, it was definitely the biggest and the best community activity Thamesmead and Abbey Wood residents have ever seen!**

**Julian Martin (right) Chief Executive of Trust Thamesmead said "We are delighted with the response from the Community, who all pulled together to make it an excellent day. It was definitely a day Trust Thamesmead will remember". We welcome your comments on the Festival, fill in the comments slip on the back page.**





# CARNIVAL PARADE

**'Down by the Riverside'**

**Kicked off at 12.00 midday with a spectacular, colourful carnival parade. Over 2500 local people took part through the streets of Thamesmead.**

**Trust Thamesmead worked with local community groups and schools to create the magnificent costumes, floats and banners using the theme of the day 'water'.**

**The carnival parade started at the end of Harrow Manor Way and made their way to Birchmere Park inspiring onlookers who clapped and cheered as they made their way through the streets.**









# CARNIVAL PARADE










**The Carnival Parade**

**put the local people of Thamesmead and Abbey Wood in high spirits for the rest of the day.**

**Once the Carnival Parade arrived at Birchmere that's when all the fun started.**

**There was lots to do for all ages and interests with non stop activities and displays throughout the day.**

**Trust Thamesmead gave away hundreds of prizes throughout the day including CD players, colour T.V's, microwave ovens, video recorders, goodie bags, toys and sweets.**

# The Festival

The Festival saw a wide range of activities.

As well as the sports arena there was the Dance Stage which entertained the community with dance routines from the Thamesmead School of Dance and Jenny's Dance Club.

The Youth Arts Zone, and the children's Big Fun Village saw young people enjoying themselves whilst the numerous walkabout acts charmed the people of Thamesmead and Abbey Wood.







**THE COMMUNITY SPIRIT WAS OVERWHELMING**





# The Festival

















**The Dance Stage saw many breathtaking acts performing Dance routines and aerobics throughout the day.**

**The children had a great time in the Children's Big Fun Village with face painting, puppet shows, drama pieces, bouncy castles, ball ponds, assault courses, arts workshop, playful Characters, Postman Pat and they even had the chance to learn circus tricks from the professionals.**

# A PARTY ON THE GREEN!

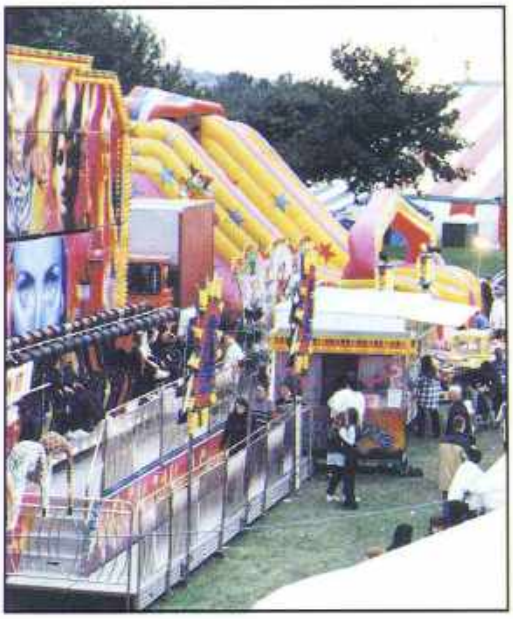
The sports arena was very popular with the youngsters.

There was the Thamesmead Street Cage Basketball Team with tournament challenges,

Charlton Athletic football coaches were teaching youngsters how to perfect their skills,

and there were also fantastic displays from Crossway Gymnastics Centre, and martial arts displays which attracted huge crowds.











# The Main Stage









## THE MAIN STAGE WAS A BIG HIT





**The Main Stage**

**pulled in huge crowds with music for all tastes. As well as Soul, jazz, Indian and Chinese music the Festival also saw performances from Chart Toppers, Lonyo and Shaft. Trevor Brown from Shaft said: "this was a brilliant day, and one of which Thamesmead can be proud".**

# Comments and suggestions








**It was an excellent day at Birchmere Park, everyone seemed to enjoy themselves at 'Down by the Riverside' Festival.**

**It was action packed and fun filled from start to finish!**

**It was a community activity which bought out the community spirit of Thamesmead and Abbey Wood people. Everyone participated and pulled together to make it a day to remember.**

**Let us know how your day was at the Millennium Festival at Birchmere Park, we welcome your feedback and suggestions!**

## Trust Thamesmead welcome your comments

Trust Thamesmead would like to know your thoughts and suggestions on the Thamesmead Millennium Festival. Please fill in the slip below and send it to Karen Nell (Editor) at Trust Thamesmead, Thamesmere Leisure Centre, Thamesmere Drive, London SE28 8RE who will be pleased to hear from you. Your thoughts will be taken into consideration whether to hold a similar event next year. Karen can also be contacted on 020 8311 4470.

**Name:** _____ **Address:** _____

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**Contact Number:** _____ **Comments:** _____

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